WORDPRESS SETUP AND OPERATIONS · 30 OCTOBER 2026

Restaurant Reservations Setup guide

A restaurant website with an editable menu and table reservations. The local stack includes WordPress, MariaDB, and Mailpit for captured test email.

> **Local result:** the site was installed from a fresh Docker volume and the reservation flow passed in Chrome and the API smoke test. The existing site is available at `http://127.0.0.1:18087/`.

1. Requirements

- Docker Desktop with Docker Compose.
- PowerShell 7 or newer for `setup.ps1`.
- Node.js for the reservation smoke test; Python and Chrome for the optional Chrome MCP check.
- Free local ports 18087 and 18088, or two other free ports.

2. First local installation

Open PowerShell in the project directory. Check ports, set a unique admin password for this shell session, then run setup:

```
Get-NetTCPConnection -LocalPort 18087,18088 -State Listen -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue
$env:WP_ADMIN_PASSWORD = 'choose-a-long-unique-password'
.\setup.ps1
Remove-Item Env:WP_ADMIN_PASSWORD
```

On the first run, `setup.ps1` creates a private `.env` with random database passwords. It starts only this Compose project, installs WordPress, activates the theme, sets Post name permalinks and the Manila timezone, and creates the four pages and seven menu dishes. Running it again preserves existing bookings and the admin password.

Open `http://127.0.0.1:18087/`. On a fresh installation, sign in at `/wp-admin/` as `site_admin` with the password you chose. An existing installation keeps its original admin account. Open the captured email inbox at `http://127.0.0.1:18088/`.

If either default port is occupied, run `.\setup.ps1 -SitePort 18089 -MailpitPort 18090` using free ports. On a fresh install you can also supply `-AdminUser`, `-AdminEmail`, and `-SiteUrl`.

3. Edit and operate the site

Task	Where
Edit dishes, prices, categories, and images	WordPress Admin → Menu dishes
View bookings and guest details	WordPress Admin → Reservations
Release a booking slot	Move that reservation to Trash
Review test emails	Mailpit on local port 18088

Guest bookings accept parties of 1–8, dates up to 60 days ahead, and at least two hours' notice. A booking is complete when its reference appears on the confirmation page. A database lock enforces the current ten-party limit per 90-minute slot for simultaneous website requests. Set capacity to the real floor plan before launch.

4. Verify the installation

```
docker compose ps
node qa/reservation-smoke.mjs
node qa/capacity-smoke.mjs
python qa/chrome-mcp-check.py
```

The reservation test checks errors, booking confirmation, Mailpit delivery, and cleanup. The capacity test sends twelve simultaneous requests, accepts at most ten, and removes its test bookings. The Chrome MCP test checks navigation, menu filtering, mobile layout, and a browser booking. These checks need the local site running on the default ports.

To stop only this project, run `docker compose down`. Its database and WordPress volumes remain. Do not use `down -v` unless you intentionally want to erase its bookings and content.

5. Files and configuration

Path	Purpose
`theme/`	Deployable WordPress theme; mounted read-only in Docker
`compose.yaml`	Local WordPress, database, Mailpit, and WP-CLI services
`.env`	Private local database credentials and ports; excluded from Git
`setup.ps1`	Repeatable WordPress setup
`qa/`	Automated checks and review screenshots

Changing `DB_PASSWORD` in `.env` after a database already exists does not rotate its database user. Preserve the original value or perform an actual database password rotation. Keep `.env`, database backups, and guest records private.

6. Install on WordPress and verify a VPS

Restaurant Reservations · Local setup and deployment assessment

> **Live deployment is not yet verified.** The tested Compose stack is local only: WordPress binds to localhost and email goes to Mailpit. Use a standard WordPress installation on the VPS, then complete the checks below before accepting real guest data.

1. Install current WordPress with a supported PHP and database stack. Copy `theme/` to `wp-content/themes/salo/` or upload it as a theme ZIP; activate **Restaurant Reservations**. Set the homepage to **Home**, Post name permalinks, and the **Asia/Manila** timezone.
2. Put WordPress behind a reverse proxy with a real domain and valid HTTPS certificate. Set WordPress Address and Site Address to the HTTPS domain; verify login, assets, and booking redirects.
3. Install and configure a WordPress SMTP delivery plugin with the mail provider's authenticated settings. The theme sends through WordPress `wp_mail()`. Do not set `RESTAURANT_DEMO_MAILPIT_HOST` on the VPS. Send a plugin test email, then submit a real test booking and confirm delivery to both guest and administrator inboxes.
4. Set the ten-party slot capacity to match the restaurant's actual tables. The database lock prevents simultaneous website submissions from exceeding that limit; staff must also respect it when entering bookings manually.
5. Replace initial address, opening hours, dishes, prices, photos, and contact instructions. Add a privacy notice and a working cancellation/contact path.
6. Add abuse protection to the public form, keep WordPress/themes/plugins patched, and use strong unique admin and database credentials. Back up the database and `wp-content` off the VPS, test restoration, and monitor site health and failed mail.

The local capacity and Mailpit tests passed. A live VPS, HTTPS, backup restore, and real SMTP delivery cannot be certified without the target server, domain, and mail-provider configuration. Do not publish the local `.env` or test admin credentials.

References

WP-CLI install command · Official WordPress Docker image · Docker Compose environment variables · WordPress backup guidance